



Carnegie Mellon University
Master of
Software Engineering

Module uses view

LG Architecture Training Program

Paulo Merson

Agenda



GenAI with
design
diagrams

Module views

View showing module decomposition



View showing module use

Layered style

MVC style

Data model/domain model

Hexagonal architecture

Microkernel pattern

Module uses view

- It shows what other modules each module uses
- This usage dependency creates coupling between modules
- Loops should be avoided



Coupling



- Coupling refers to the degree of interdependence between software elements
 - It's also the probability that a modification to one module will propagate to the other [Bass21]
- Removing coupling altogether is not a design goal; coupling between software modules is essential to build applications
- The goal is to limit coupling to the minimum necessary

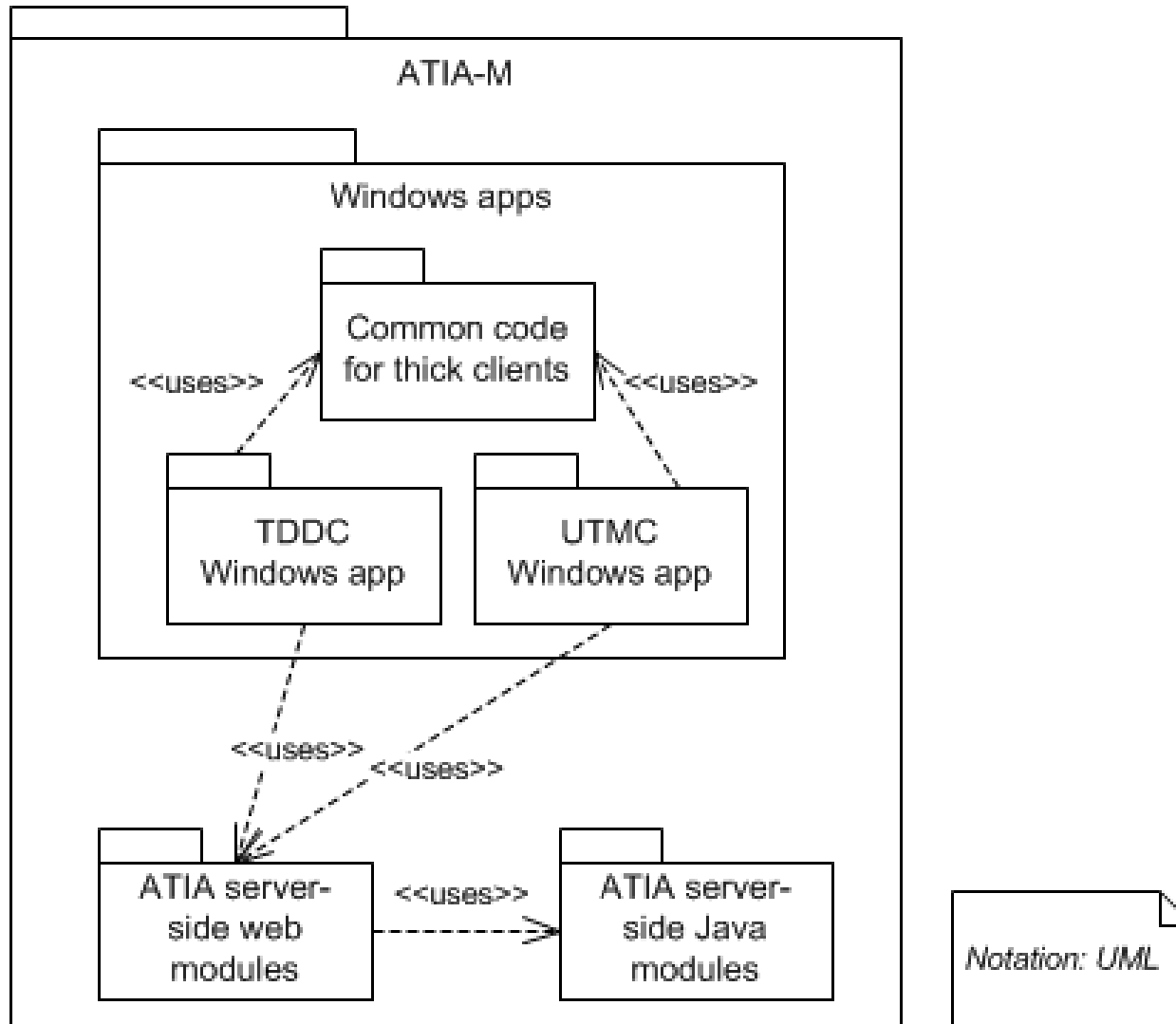
*We want **loose coupling**
(aka low coupling)*



*We avoid **tight coupling**
(aka high coupling)*

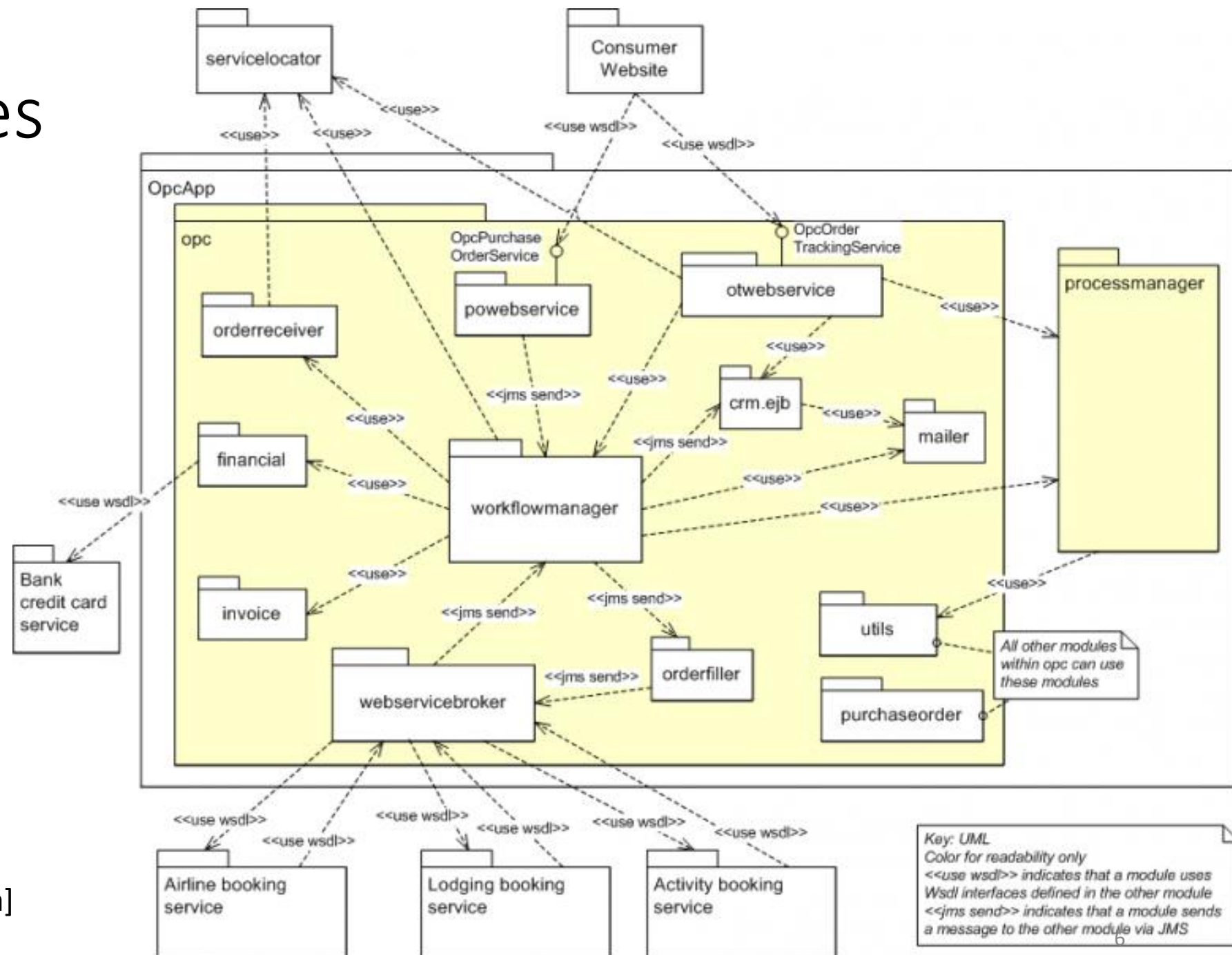


Module uses view – example 1



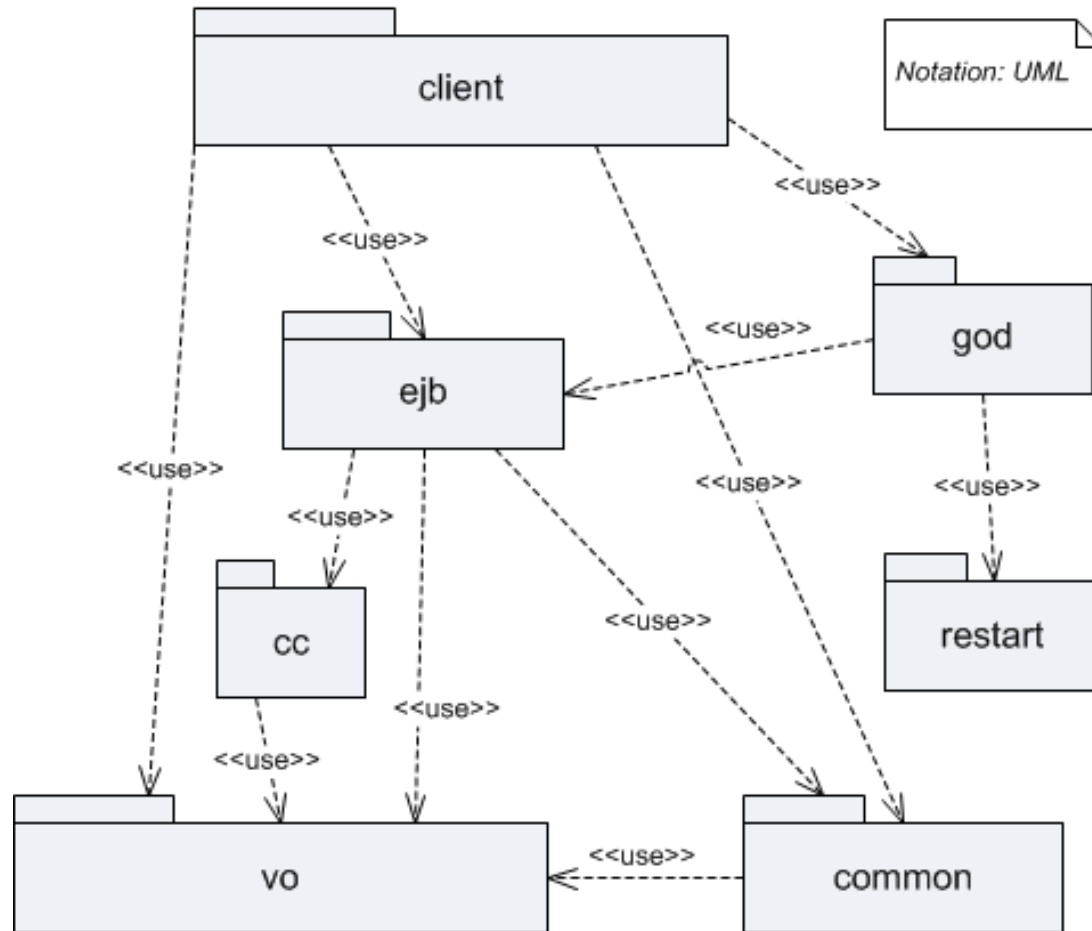
Source: [Smith03]

Module uses view – example 2



Fonte: [Merson13a]

Module uses view – example 3

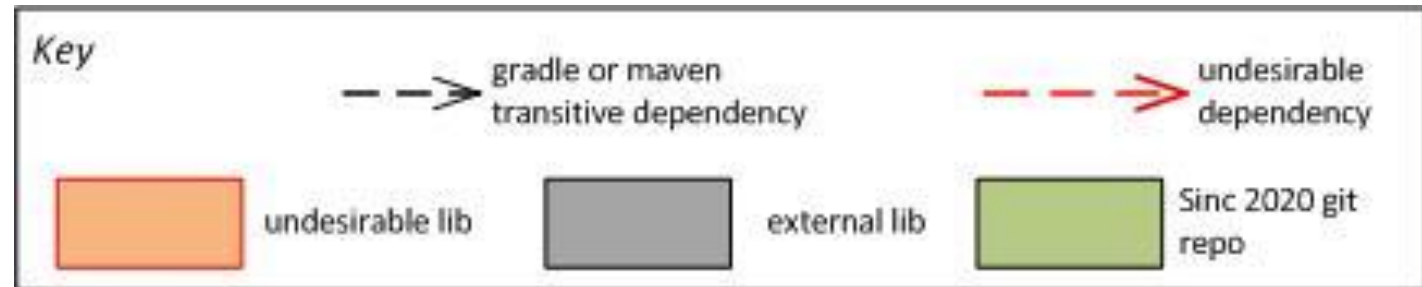
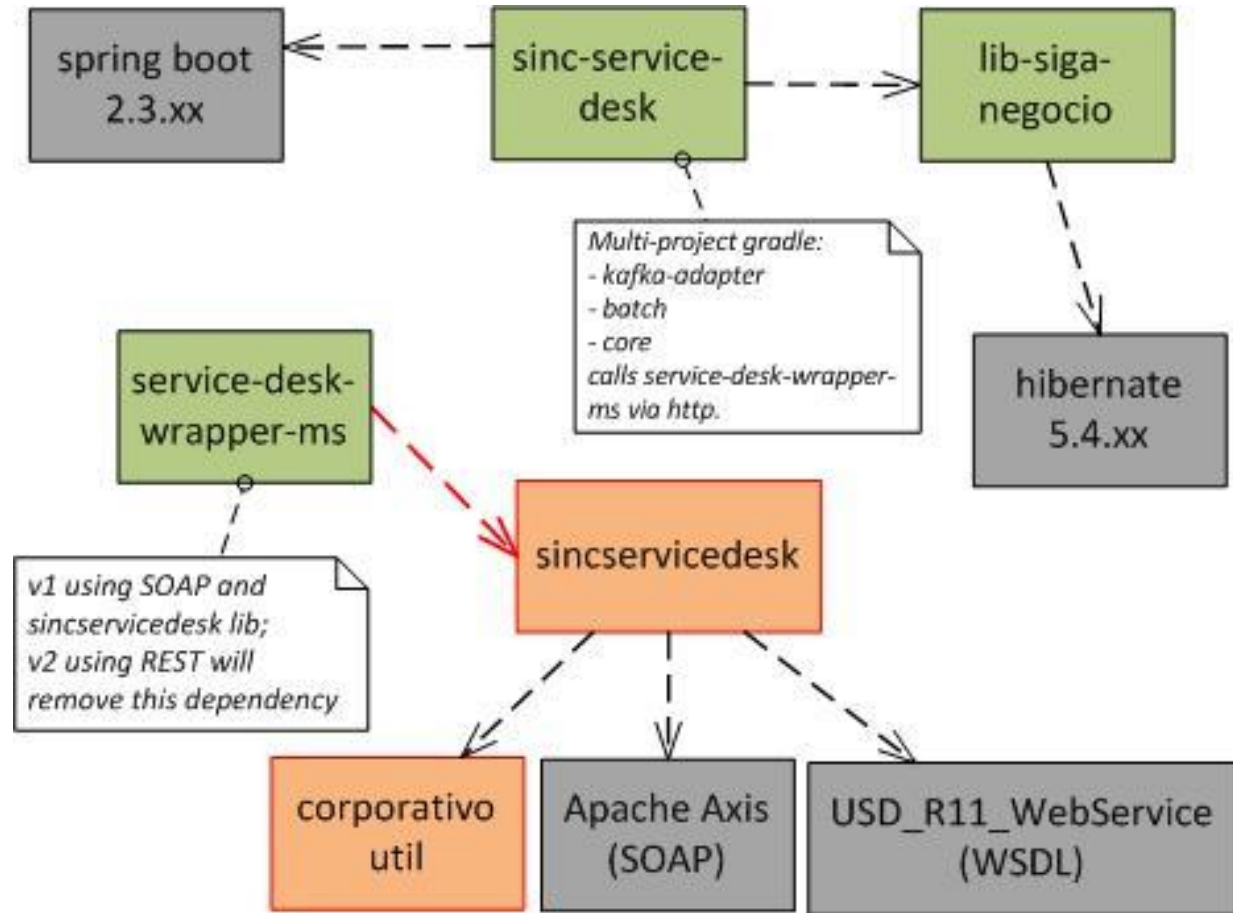


using module \ used module	client	ejb	cc	god	restart	common	vo
client	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
ejb	1	0	0	1	0	0	0
cc	0	1	0	0	0	0	0
god	1	0	0	0	0	0	0
restart	0	0	0	1	0	0	0
common	1	1	0	0	0	0	0
vo	1	1	1	0	0	1	0

On the right is the Dependency Structure Matrix (DSM) of the diagram on the left

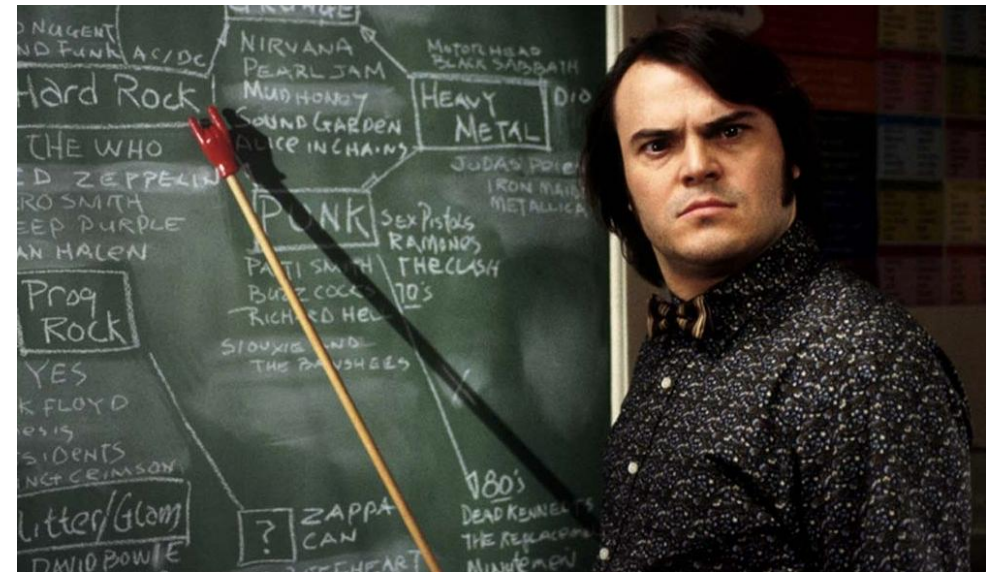
Key: '1' means module in column uses module in row

Module uses view – example 4

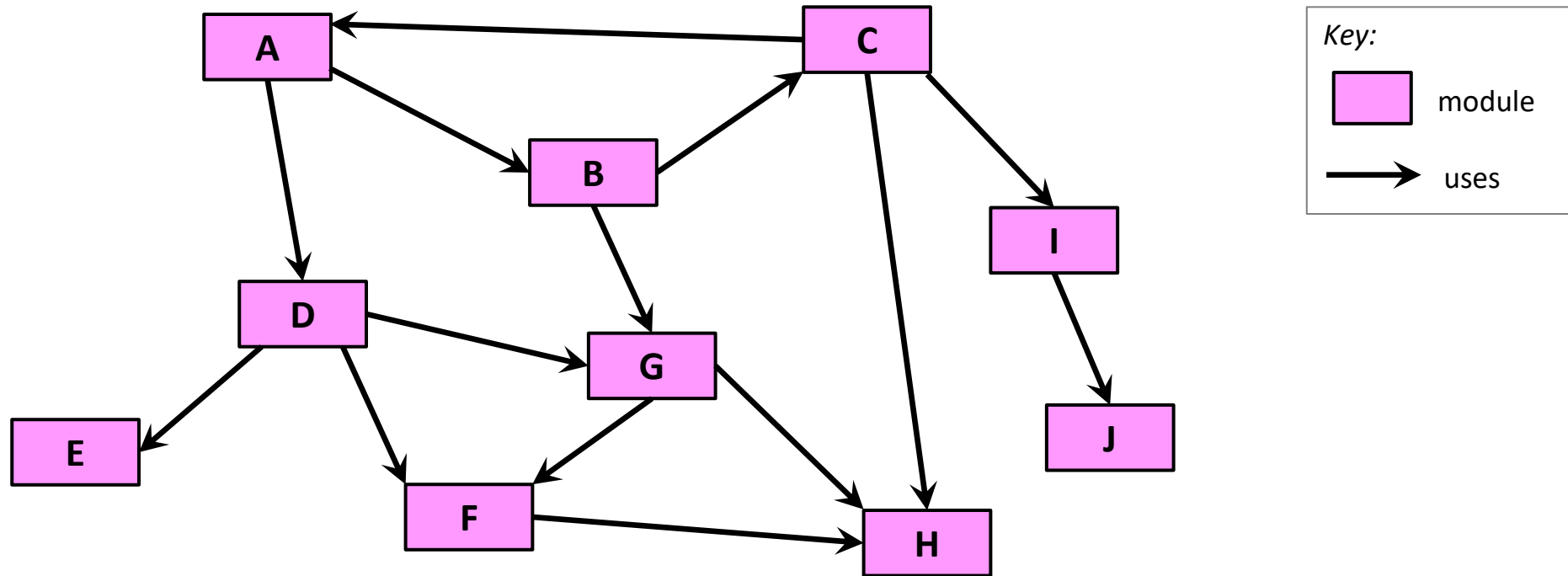


Uses of the module uses view

- Onboarding of new developers
- Guide testing and debugging
- Define task allocation and project schedules
- Plan incremental development
- Impact analysis
- Guide refactorings



Uses view is key to incremental development



*What modules are required if I want module C in the next release?
And now?*

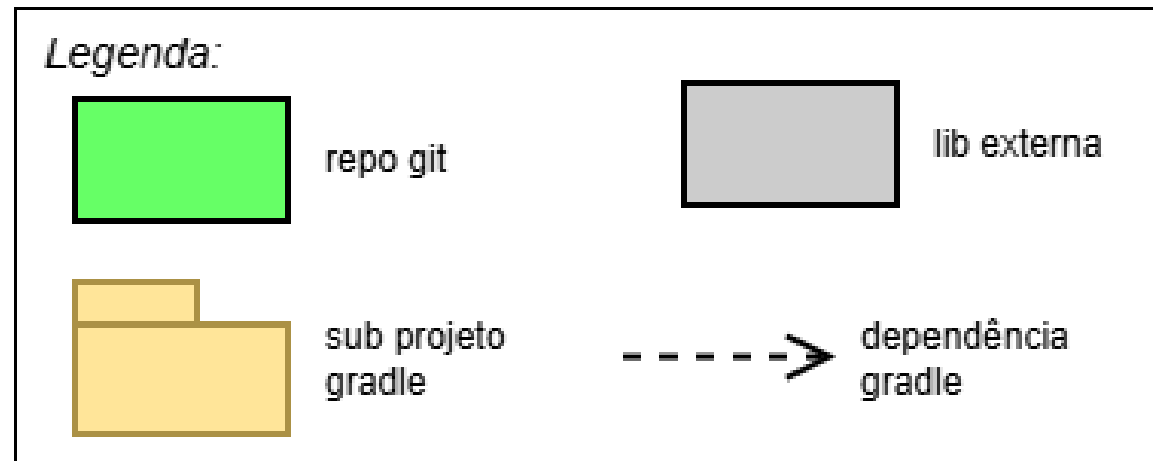


*GenAI can help you
to create module
uses diagrams!*

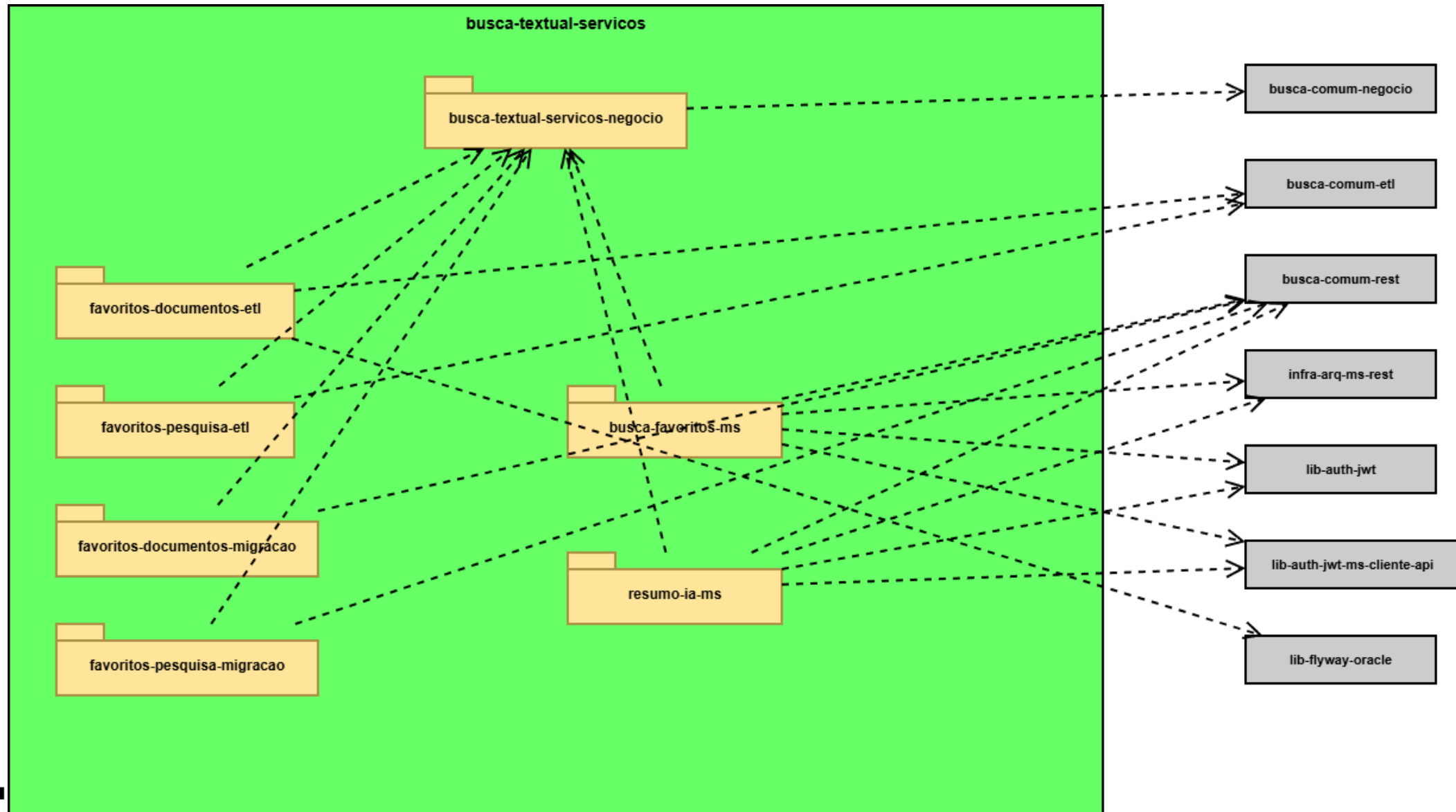
*But if the code
doesn't exist yet, it
might be easier if
you create the
diagram!*

Example: Claude Sonnet creating a .drawio diagram

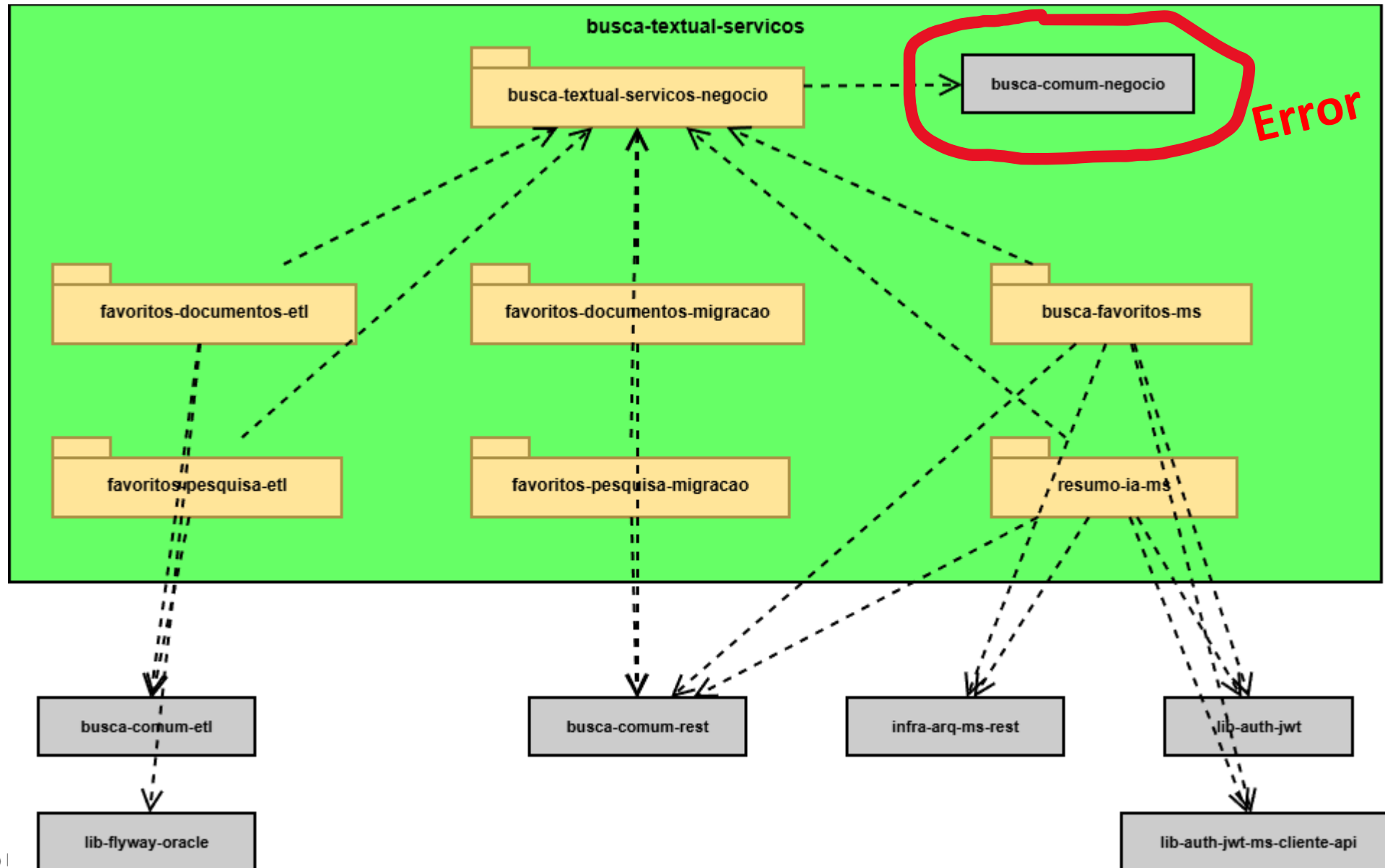
- Prompt contained
 - A very simple notation key (as a .drawio file) shown below
 - Location of a git repo
 - Instructions to map code constructs to elements in the diagram



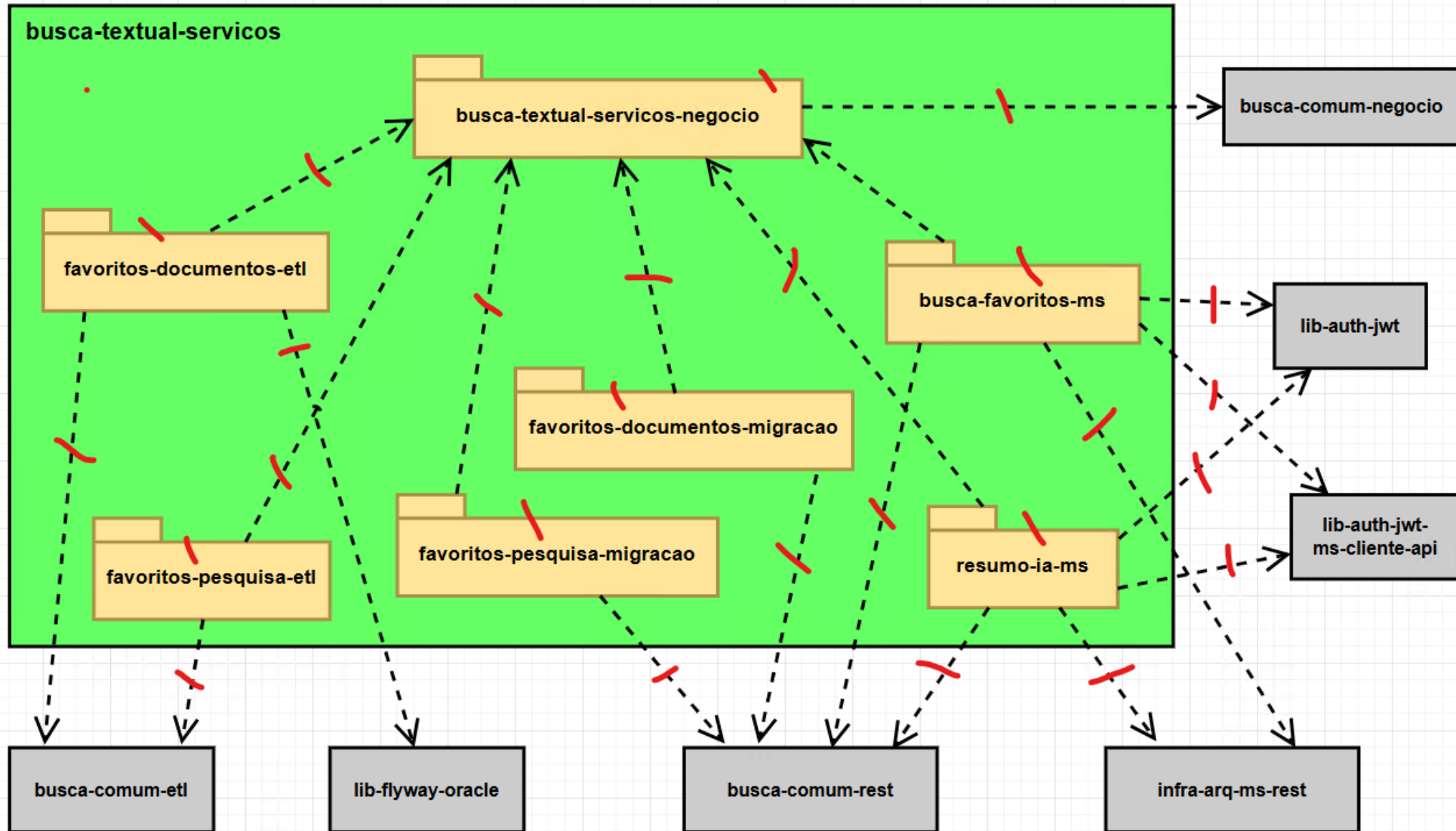
Version 1 created by Claude Sonnet



Version 2 after asking for a “planar graph”

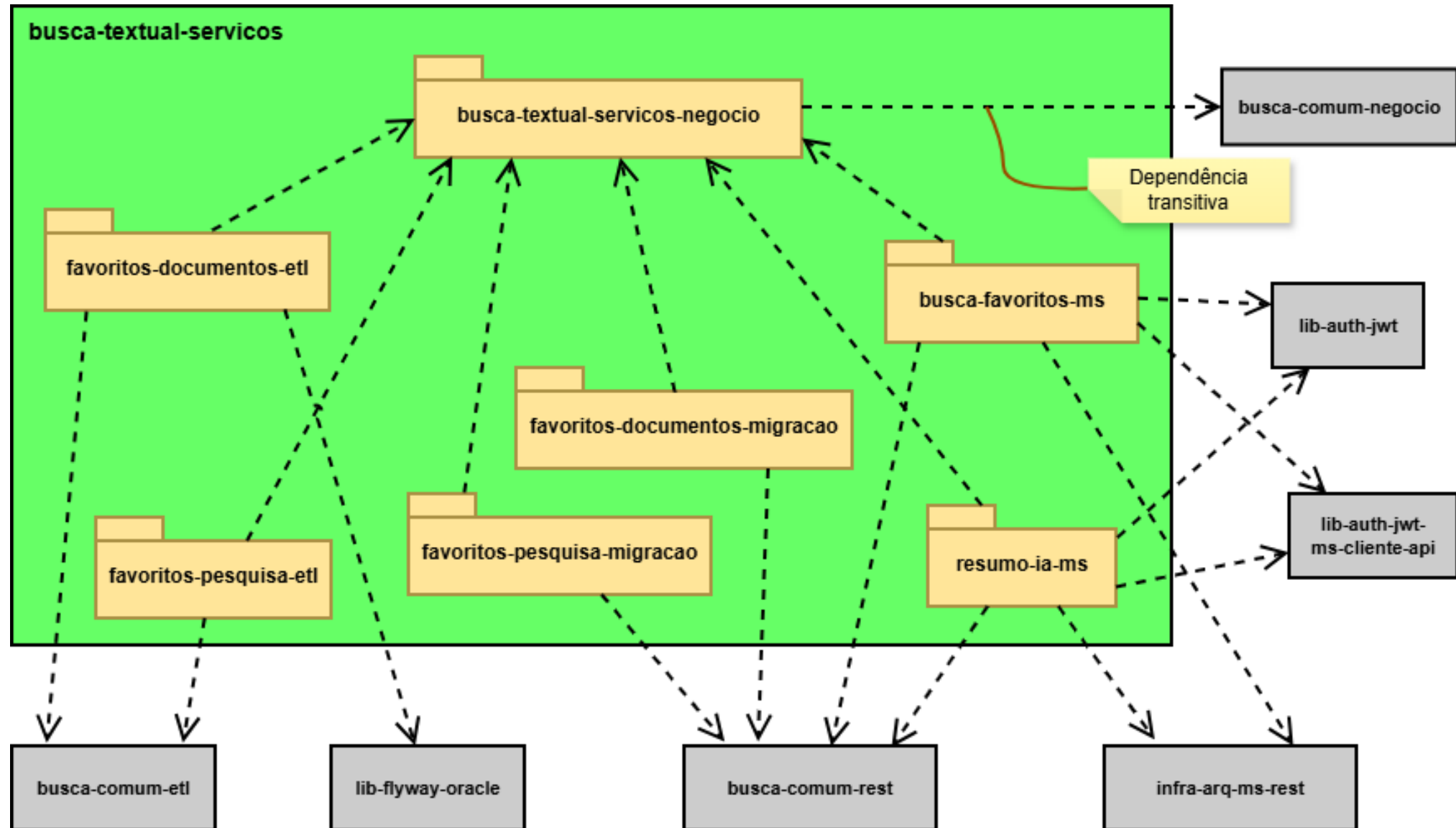


Version 3 after manual reorg of boxes and fix



Red ticks
for manual
verification

Version 4 with final manual adjustments



Using GenAI with design diagrams

- Requires a tool that works with a machine-readable file format
- Examples of tools:
 - **Drawio** (diagrams.net) uses XML 😊
 - **Excalidraw** uses JSON 😊
 - **Mermaid** is text-based but limits the types of diagrams and what can be customized 😐
 - **Miro** and **Mural** don't save diagrams in text format 😞
 - **Enterprise Architect** and **ArchiMate** can export XML but are full-fledged modeling tools 😬
- Diagram creation should allow roundtrip engineering

Like any GenAI non-deterministic output, diagrams should be reviewed by a human



Questions?

Paulo Merson
pmerson@cmu.edu